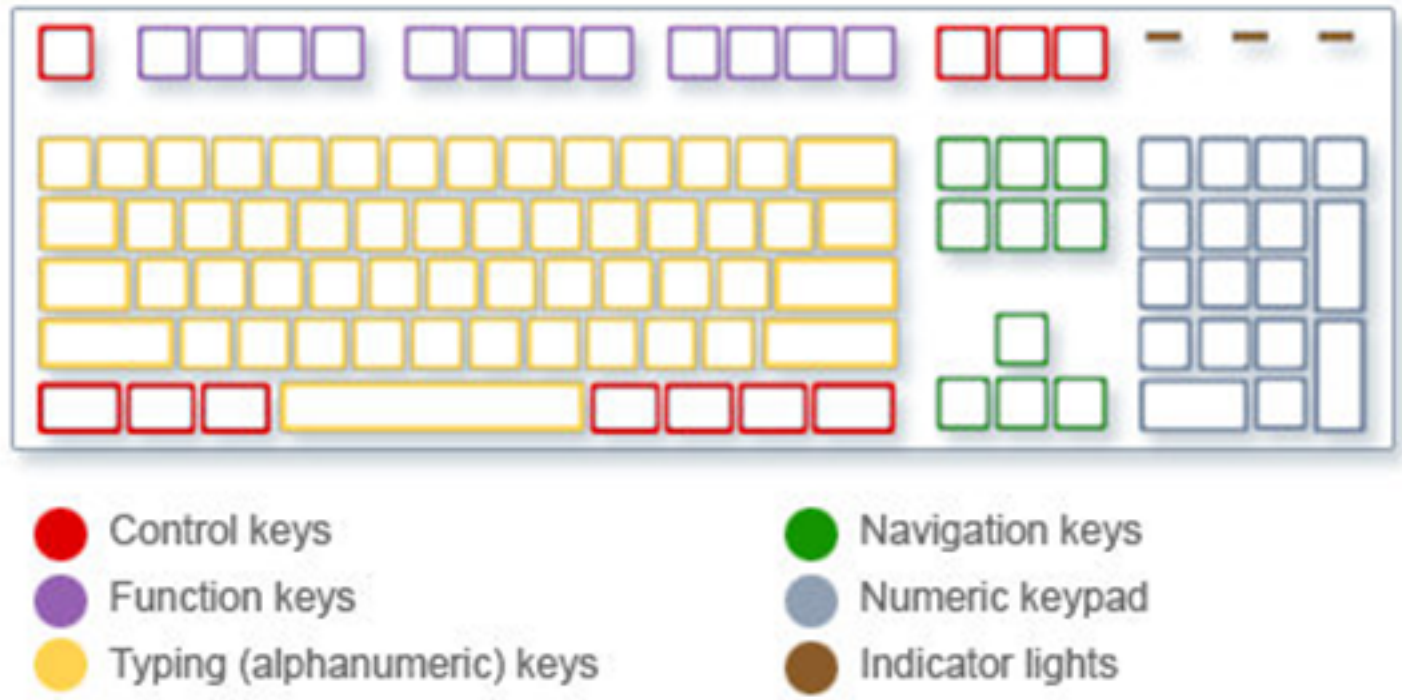
Using your keyboard

- Keyboard is the main way to enter information into your computer.
- You can also use your keyboard to control your computer.
- Learning just a few simple keyboard commands (instructions to your computer) can help you work more efficiently.

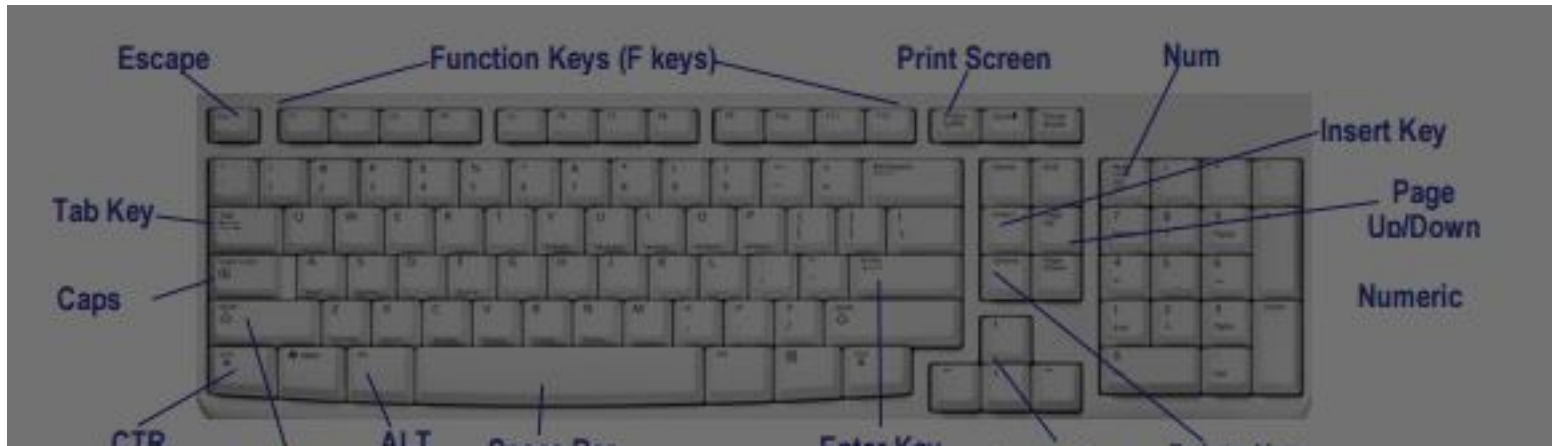
How the keys are organized

- The keys on the keyboard can be divided into several groups based on function:
- **Typing (alphanumeric) keys**. These keys include the same letter, number, punctuation, and symbol keys found on a traditional typewriter.
- **Control keys** - These keys are used alone or in combination with other keys to perform certain actions. The most frequently used control keys are Ctrl, Alt, the Windows logo key and Esc.
- **Function keys**. The function keys are used to perform specific tasks. They are labeled as F1, F2, F3 and so on, up to F12. The functionality of these keys differs from program to program.
- **Navigation keys** - These keys are used for moving around in documents or webpages and editing text. They include the arrow keys, Home, End, Page Up, Page Down, Delete, and Insert.
- **Numeric keypad** - The numeric keypad is handy for entering numbers quickly. The keys are grouped together in a block like a conventional calculator or adding machine.

- The following illustration shows how these keys are arranged on a typical keyboard. Some keyboard layout might be different.



How the keys are arranged on a keyboard



Typing text

- Whenever you need to type something in a program, e- mail message or text box, you'll see a blinking vertical line (I).
- That's the cursor also called the insertion point.
- It shows where the text that you type will begin.
- You can move the cursor by clicking in the desired location with the mouse, or by using the navigation keys.
- In addition to letters, numerals, punctuation marks, and symbols, Typing keys also include Shift, Caps Lock, Tab, Enter, the Spacebar and Backspace.

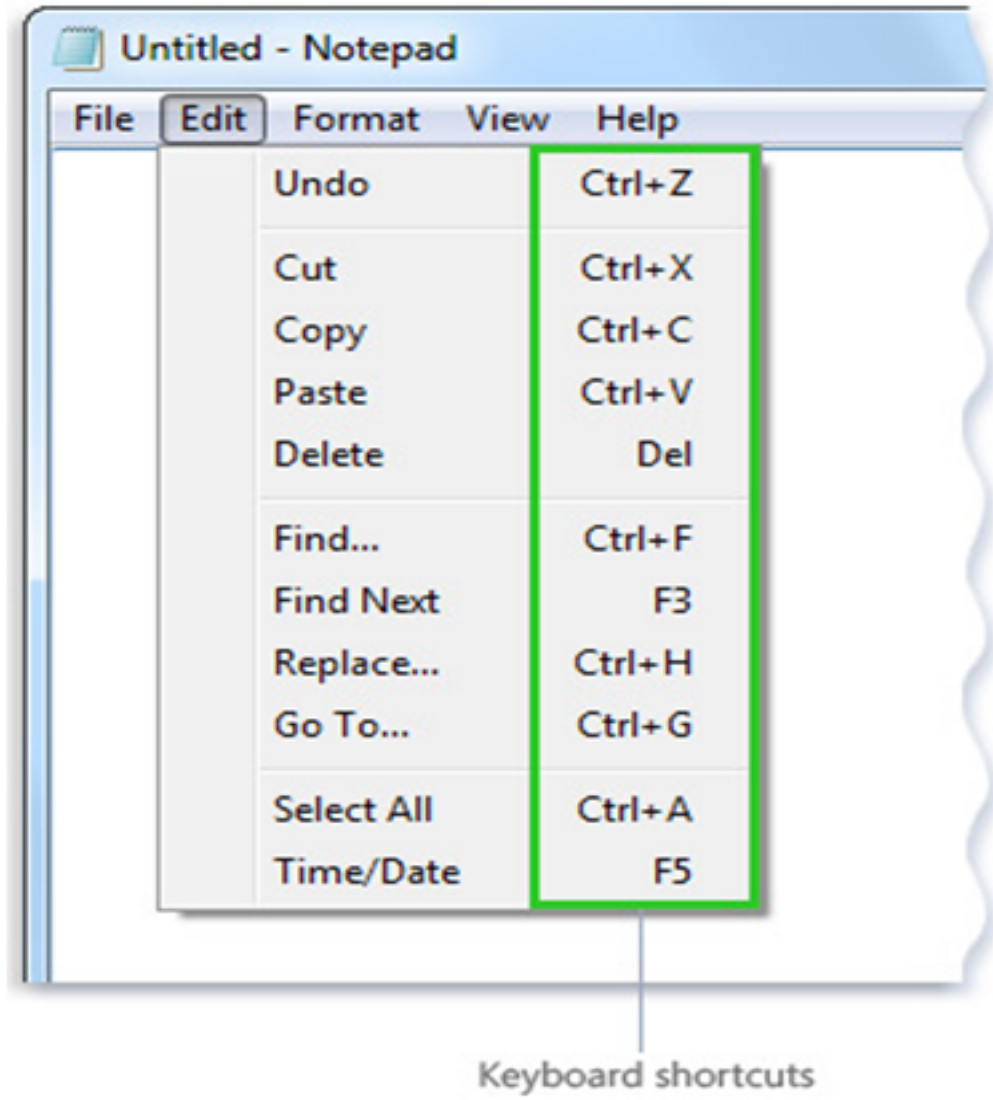
Key name	How to use it
Shift	Press Shift in combination with a letter to type an uppercase letter. Press Shift in combination with another key to type the symbol shown on the upper part of that key.
Caps Lock	Press Caps Lock once to type all letters as uppercase. Press Caps Lock again to turn this function off. Your keyboard might have a light indicating whether Caps Lock is on.
Tab	Press Tab to move the cursor several spaces forward. You can also press Tab to move to the next text box on a form.
Enter	Press Enter to move the cursor to the beginning of the next line. In a dialog box, press Enter to select the highlighted button.
Spacebar	Press the Spacebar to move the cursor one space forward.
Backspace	Press Backspace to delete the character before the cursor, or the selected text.

Using keyboard shortcuts

- Keyboard shortcuts are ways to perform actions by using your keyboard.
- They're called shortcuts because they help you work faster.
- Almost any action or command performed with a mouse can be performed faster using one or more keys on the keyboard.
- A plus sign (+) between two or more keys indicates that those keys should be pressed in combination.
  - E.g. Ctrl+A means to press and hold Ctrl and then press A. Ctrl+Shift+A means to press and hold Ctrl and Shift and then press A.

Find program shortcuts

- You can do things in most programs by using the keyboard. To see which commands have keyboard shortcuts, open a menu. The shortcuts (if available) are shown next to the menu items



Keyboard shortcuts appear next to menu items.

Useful shortcuts

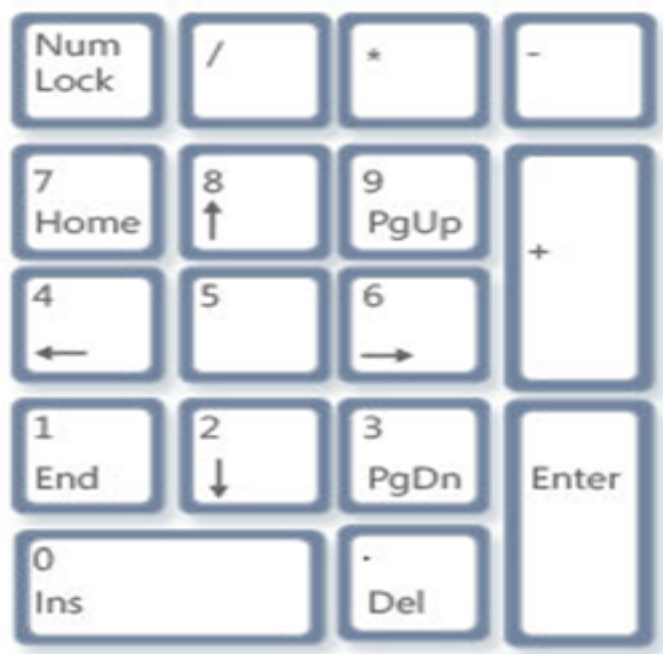
The following table lists some of the most useful keyboard shortcuts.

Press this	To do this
Windows logo key	Open the Start menu
Alt+Tab	Switch between open programs or windows
Alt+F4	Close the active item, or exit the active program
Ctrl+S	Save the current file or document (works in most programs)
Ctrl+C	Copy the selected item
Ctrl+X	Cut the selected item
Ctrl+V	Paste the selected item
Ctrl+Z	Undo an action
Ctrl+A	Select all items in a document or window
F1	Display Help for a program or Windows
Windows logo key +F1	Display Windows Help and Support
Esc	Cancel the current task
Application key	Open a menu of commands related to a selection in a program. Equivalent to right-clicking the selection.

Press this	To do this
Left Arrow, Right Arrow, Up Arrow, or Down Arrow	Move the cursor or selection one space or line in the direction of the arrow, or scroll a webpage in the direction of the arrow
Home	Move the cursor to the beginning of a line or move to the top of a webpage
End	Move the cursor to the end of a line or move to the bottom of a webpage
Ctrl+Home	Move to the top of a document
Ctrl+End	Move to the bottom of a document
Page Up	Move the cursor or page up one screen
Page Down	Move the cursor or page down one screen
Delete	Delete the character after the cursor, or the selected text; in Windows, delete the selected item and move it to the Recycle Bin
Insert	Turn Insert mode off or on. When Insert mode is on, text that you type is inserted at the cursor. When Insert mode is off, text that you type replaces existing characters.

Using the numeric keypad

- The numeric keypad arranges the numerals 0 though 9, the arithmetic operators + (addition), - (subtraction), * (multiplication), and / (division), and the decimal point as they would appear on a calculator or adding machine.
- These characters are duplicated elsewhere on the keyboard, but the keypad arrangement allows you to quickly enter numerical data or mathematical operations with one hand.



Numeric keypad

- To use the numeric keypad to enter numbers, press Num Lock.
- Most keyboards have a light that indicates whether Num Lock is on or off.
- When Num Lock is off, the numeric keypad functions as a second set of navigation keys (these functions are printed on the keys next to the numerals or symbols).
- You can use numeric keypad to perform simple calculations with Calculator.

Three odd keys

- Let's explore the three most mysterious keys on the keyboard: PrtScn, Scroll Lock and Pause/Break.

PrtScn (or Print Screen)

- A long time ago, this key actually did what it says—it sent the current screen of text to your printer. Nowadays, pressing PrtScn captures an image of your entire screen (a "screen shot") and copies it to the Clipboard in the computer's memory. From there you can paste it (Ctrl+V) into Microsoft Paint or another program and, if you want, print it from that program.
- More obscure is SYS RQ, which shares the key with PrtScn on some keyboards. Historically, SYS RQ was designed to be a "system request," but this command is not enabled in Windows.

Tip

- Press Alt+PrtScn to capture an image of just the active window, instead of the entire screen.

ScrLk (or Scroll Lock)

- In most programs, pressing Scroll Lock has no effect. In a few programs, pressing Scroll Lock changes the behavior of the arrow keys and the Page Up and Page Down keys; pressing these keys causes the document to scroll without changing the position of the cursor or selection. Your keyboard might have a light indicating whether Scroll Lock is on.

Pause/Break

- This key is rarely used. In some older programs, pressing this key pauses the program or, in combination with Ctrl, stops it from running.

Tips for using your keyboard safely

- Using your keyboard properly can help avoid soreness or injury to your wrists, hands, and arms, particularly if you use your computer for long periods of time.
- Here are some tips to help you avoid problems:
- Place your keyboard at elbow level. Your upper arms should be relaxed at your sides.
- Center your keyboard in front of you. If your keyboard has a numeric keypad, you can use the spacebar as the centering point.
- Type with your hands and wrists floating above the keyboard, so that you can use your whole arm to reach for distant keys instead of stretching your fingers.
- Avoid resting your palms or wrists on any type of surface while typing. If your keyboard has a palm rest, use it only during breaks from typing.
- While typing, use a light touch and keep your wrists straight.
- When you're not typing, relax your arms and hands.
- Take short breaks from computer use every 15 to 20 minutes.